OFFICIAL TECHNICAL STATUS REPORT

Brief! - verified, deployed, and live

Application 2.3.0 | Report v6 | First real run, first deployment, briefmessage.net

Project	Brief! - a full-stack web application; a message board where every post fits in 255 characters. Live at https://briefmessage.net since October 11, 2026.
Author	Ambroise Lumanikio (OneTechly, LLC)
Version covered	2.3.0 (Spring Boot edition and web app). No code has changed since OTSR v5; this report records what happened when that code met the real world.
Report	OTSR v6 | October 11, 2026 | follows OTSR v5 (October 9, 2026)
Overall status	**2.3.0 is verified:** 207 of 207 tests on the real stack, on H2 and on PostgreSQL. **It is deployed:** one web service and one PostgreSQL database on Render, created from render.yaml. **The domain answers over HTTPS.** Milestones M0, M1 and M2 of the launch roadmap are closed, with four small confirmations left (Section 10).
Most important open item	**The site is open to the world.** Anyone who finds the address can register and post. Section 10, item 1.

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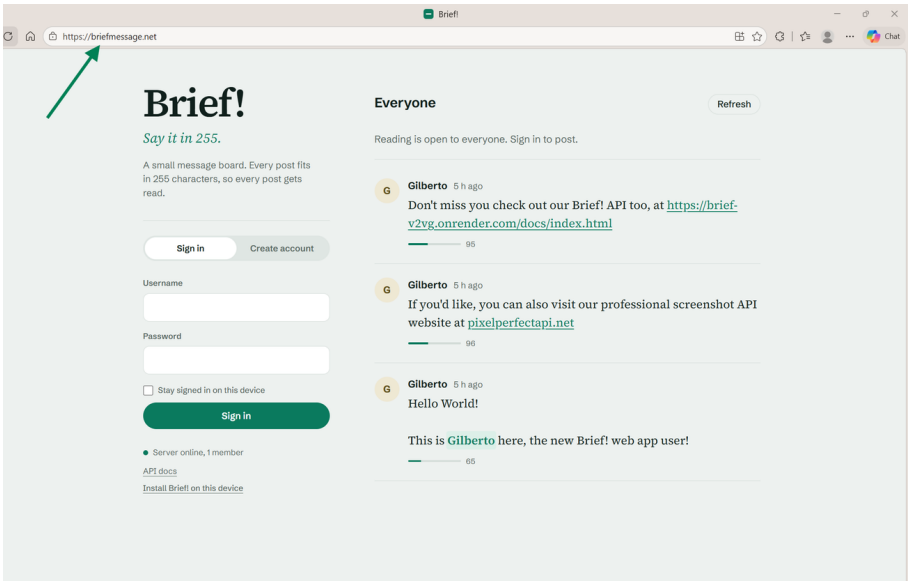
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1. Summary

OTSR v5 closed with 2.3.0 written and checked on a stand-in for Spring, and one open action: run it for real. In the two days since, it was run, pushed, built into a Docker image, deployed, and connected to its domain. Everything in the table below was done by the author on real systems; this report only records and reviews it.

Item	At OTSR v5 (Oct 9)	Now (Oct 11)	Status
2.3.0 automated suite	207 tests written; real run not yet done	**207 of 207** on the author's machine (H2); BUILD SUCCESS for test and package	DONE
The same suite on PostgreSQL	Run on a stand-in only	**Passed on real Spring and PostgreSQL 16** in GitHub Actions	DONE
Docker image	Never built	Built and started in GitHub Actions; built and deployed by Render	DONE
Source repository	A zip file	github.com/Ambro19/brief, branch main, CI on every push	DONE
Deployment	Nothing deployed	Render Blueprint: web service "brief" and database "brief-db", both in Virginia	LIVE
Database in production	-	PostgreSQL 16.15; Flyway applied V1 and V2 to the empty database; data survived a redeploy	DONE
Domain	Registered, no DNS records	briefmessage.net and www verified by Render, certificates issued, DNSSEC active	LIVE
Email at the domain	None	hello@ and support@ forward to the owner's inbox; hello@ tested	DONE
Architecture diagram	None	One page, color and black-and-white (Section 5)	DONE
Who can use the site	Only the author's computer	Anyone on the internet, with no bot check and no moderation tools	OPEN

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https://briefmessage.net on October 11, 05:39. The three posts were written five hours earlier at the onrender.com address, before the forced push that redeployed the service. Screenshot by the author.

> **Before telling anyone the address**
>
> Brief! 2.3.0 was built to be deployable, not yet to be public. There is no bot check, no email on accounts, no way to remove an account or another member's post, and one board that everyone shares. That is fine for you and people you invite to look. It is not ready for strangers. Release 2.4 adds a closed mode (Section 11); until then, share the address person to person only.

2. Decisions Recorded

#	Decision	Outcome	Decided by, when
1	One milestone per release	Confirmed. 2.3.0 was M1 only, and its first real run was clean.	Author, Oct 10
2	How Brief! is hosted	One Render web service that serves the API and the web app, plus one database. No separate frontend service. Same Render account and workspace as PixelPerfect.	Author, Oct 10
3	Study copy of 2.3.0	Not needed. The standard copy is the only copy.	Author, Oct 10
4	Service that sends Brief!'s email	Resend, on its free plan to start. The author creates the account.	Author, Oct 11
5	Name of the web app folder	**frontend-spring**, from release 2.4.	Author, Oct 11
6	Repository name	Stays **brief**. GitHub does not allow "!" in a repository name.	-
7	Cloudflare proxy in front of Render	Off (DNS only) for now. Render supports both; grey is one layer fewer.	Author, Oct 11
8	Cross-promotion with PixelPerfect	One quiet line for signed-out visitors ("Also from OneTechly"), in 2.4. Not a banner in the feed.	Proposed; not yet confirmed

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#	Decision	Outcome	Decided by, when
9	Is the repository public?	It is public today, including the docs folder with roadmap and pricing ideas.	**Open: the author's call**

3. Verification Record: the Real Runs

The author's Windows machine: Java 17.0.11, Maven through the Maven Wrapper.

Release	Command and date	Result	Status
Spring 2.3.0	`.\mvnw.cmd package` Oct 9, 19:02	**Tests run: 207, Failures: 0, Errors: 0, Skipped: 0** BUILD SUCCESS, 1 min 08 s; brief-spring.jar built	**PASS**
Spring 2.3.0	`.\mvnw.cmd test` Oct 10, 19:44	**Tests run: 207, Failures: 0, Errors: 0, Skipped: 0** BUILD SUCCESS, 1 min 15 s	**PASS**
Spring 2.2.0 (run again)	`.\mvnw.cmd test` Oct 10, 21:55	**Tests run: 149, Failures: 0, Errors: 0, Skipped: 0** BUILD SUCCESS, 54 s	**PASS**

Stack as the log shows it: Spring Boot 3.3.5, Hibernate ORM 6.5.3.Final, Apache Tomcat 10.1.31, Flyway against H2 2.2, three JPA repositories found.

Suite by suite, 2.3.0, as run on October 10

Suite	Expected (OTSR v5)	Ran	Time
ContractTest (end to end, compat mode)	58	58	21.6 s
StrictAuthTest (end to end, strict mode)	21	21	6.6 s
AccountServiceTest	17	17	2.8 s
MentionServiceTest	22	22	0.3 s
LoginRateLimiterTest	15	15	**21.3 s** (Section 8, item 5)
MessageServiceTest, JwtServiceTest	15 + 12	15 + 12	under 0.1 s each
PasswordHasherTest, JwtAuthenticationFilterTest	5 + 4	5 + 4	0.9 s, under 0.1 s
AuthGuardTest, PasswordPolicyTest	5 + 5	5 + 5	under 0.1 s each
The five new unit suites: DatabaseUrl, AddressGroup, UsernamePolicy, ClientAddress, StartupReport	11 + 6 + 4 + 4 + 3	11 + 6 + 4 + 4 + 3	under 0.1 s each
Total	**207**	**207**, 0 failures, 0 errors, 0 skipped	

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What the real run proved that the stand-in could not

- **Flyway inside real Spring Boot.** The log reads `Successfully validated 2 migrations`, then `Migrating schema "PUBLIC" to version "1 - baseline schema"`, `"2 - foreign keys and username key"`, and `Successfully applied 2 migrations ... now at version v2`.
- **Hibernate's validation.** With ddl-auto=validate, the application starts only if the three entities match the tables the migrations made. It started.
- **The two new derived queries** for paged mentions, as Spring Data itself parses them: the paged-mention tests in ContractTest pass.
- **Tomcat and Spring MVC serving /assets** with the cache header, and the 79 end-to-end tests as a whole.
- **The start-up line.** `Database: H2 in memory. Everything is forgotten when the application stops.` in the tests; `Database: PostgreSQL, //dpg-...` on Render.

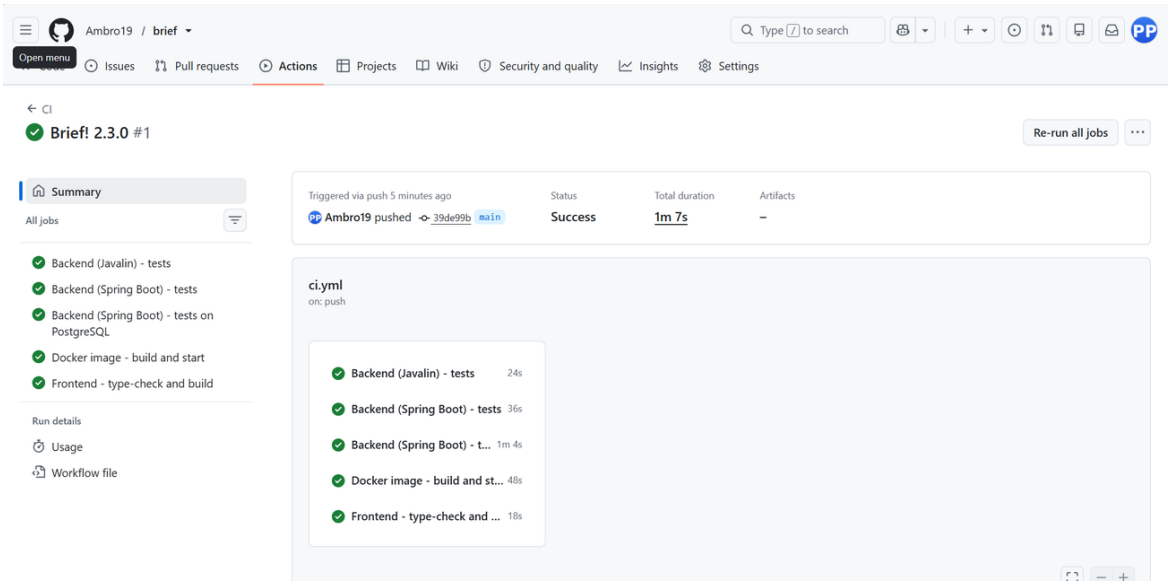
Track record of the method: six releases written without the real framework (1.0.2, 1.1.0, 2.0.0, 2.1.0, 2.2.0, 2.3.0), six first runs with zero failures. 2.3.0 was the first checked on a miniature stand-in for Spring with real databases underneath; the one defect that method missed and source reading caught (the unquoted Flyway table name, OTSR v5) would have been the first failure.

4. Continuous Integration

The first push to GitHub started the workflow in .github/workflows/ci.yml. Run #1, "Brief! 2.3.0", branch main: **Success**, 1 min 7 s in total.

Job	What it does	Result	Time
Backend (Javalin) - tests	The frozen 1.1.0 edition's suite	PASS	24 s
Backend (Spring Boot) - tests	The 207 tests on H2	PASS	36 s
Backend (Spring Boot) - tests on PostgreSQL	The same 207 tests, the end-to-end ones against a PostgreSQL 16 service	PASS	1 min 4 s
Docker image - build and start	Builds the Dockerfile, starts the container, calls /health	PASS	48 s
Frontend - type-check and build	TypeScript check and production build of the web app	PASS	18 s

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GitHub Actions, run #1. Screenshot by the author.

Two open items of OTSR v5 closed here: the Dockerfile had never been built, and the suite had never met PostgreSQL under real Spring. Both passed on the first attempt. From now on every push repeats all five jobs.

The commit that ran was 39de99b. It was later replaced by d4b7db3 (Section 8, item 1); the files that are built and tested are identical in both.

5. Deployment Record: Render

What	Value
How it was created	New > Blueprint, repository Ambro19/brief, branch main. Render read render.yaml and created both resources. Nothing was typed into a settings page.
Web service	**brief** | Docker runtime | Virginia | free plan | address https://brief-v2vg.onrender.com
Database	**brief-db** | PostgreSQL 16 (16.15) | Virginia | free plan | created October 11
Environment	BRIEF_AUTH_MODE=strict, BRIEF_JWT_SECRET (generated by Render), BRIEF_CLIENT_IP_HEADER=CF-Connecting-IP, DATABASE_URL (from brief-db). PORT set by Render: 10000.
Java in the container	17.0.20.1 (Eclipse Temurin runtime image), running as the user "brief", not root
Custom domains	briefmessage.net: verified, certificate issued. www.briefmessage.net: verified, certificate issued, redirects to briefmessage.net.

The first deploy, from the log (times in UTC, October 11)

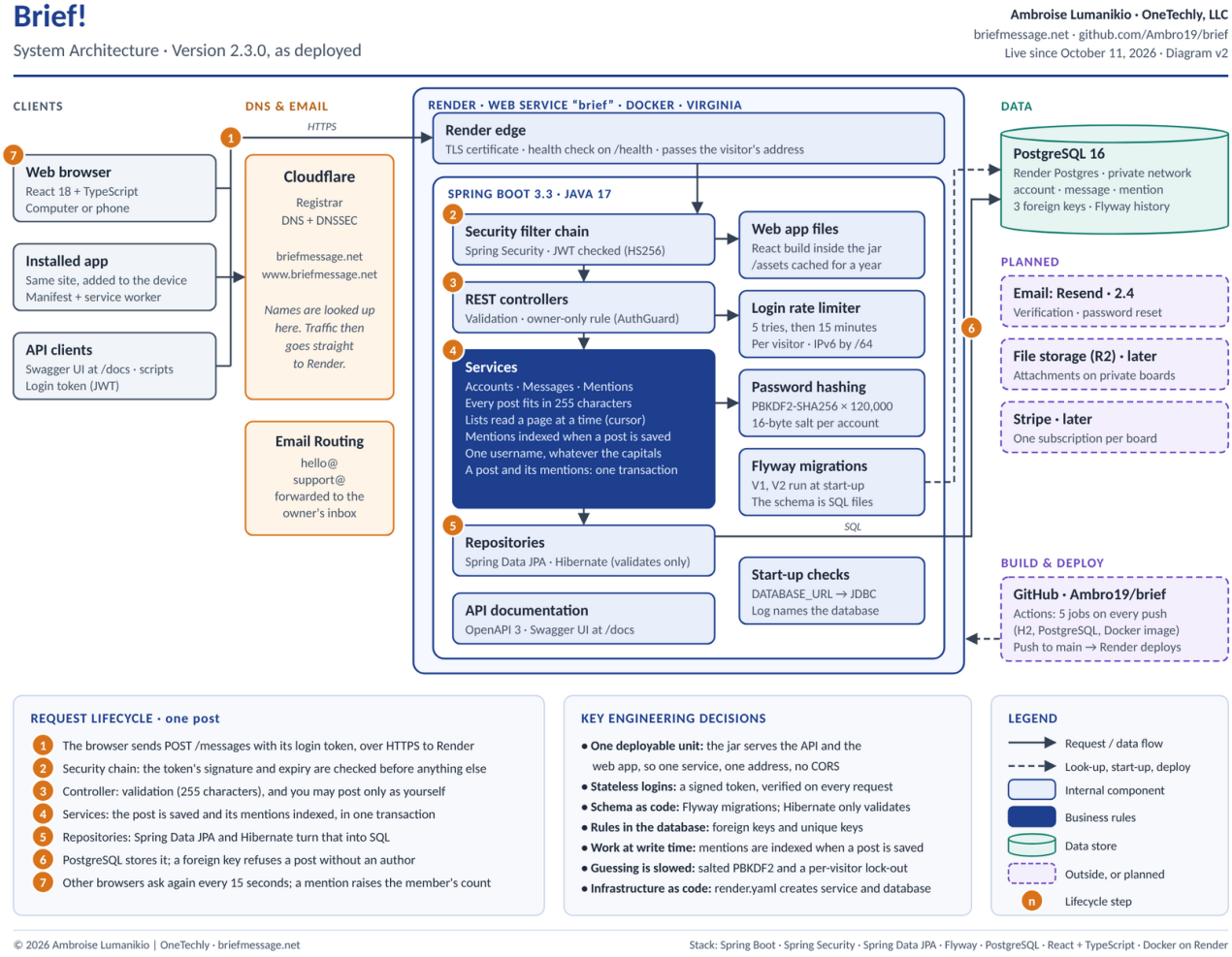
Time	Event
04:08:53	Docker build starts the Maven stage
04:09:12	`BUILD SUCCESS`, 18.4 s: 42 source files compiled, jar built and repackaged
04:09:23	Image pushed; "Deploying..."

Time	Event
04:09:42	`Starting BriefApplication v2.3.0 using Java 17.0.20.1`
04:10:23	Flyway: `Database: jdbc:postgresql://dpg-...:5432/brief_lv6o (PostgreSQL 16.15)`
04:10:27	`Current version of schema "public": << Empty Schema >>`, then V1 and V2 are applied
04:10:29	`Successfully applied 2 migrations to schema "public", now at version v2`
04:11:29	`Tomcat started on port 10000`; `Started BriefApplication in 114.699 seconds`
04:11:32	`Database: PostgreSQL, //dpg-...:5432/brief_lv6o.`
04:11:34	"Your service is live"

- **From push to live: about three and a half minutes.** The build took under a minute; the application's own start-up took almost two (Section 8, item 4).
- **Two lines marked WARN are expected:** `relation "mention" already exists, skipping` and the same for its index. V2 creates the mention table only if it is missing, for databases that come from 2.1; on a new database V1 has just created it.
- **"No open ports detected, continuing to scan..."** appears twice. It is Render waiting for a slow start, not an error.
- **The data is in PostgreSQL.** Two independent signs: the start-up line above, and the three posts that were still there five hours later, after the forced push that makes Render build and deploy again.

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System architecture, as deployed



Brief! system architecture, version 2.3.0. Also delivered as Brief_Architecture_Color.pdf and Brief_Architecture_BW.pdf, one landscape page each.

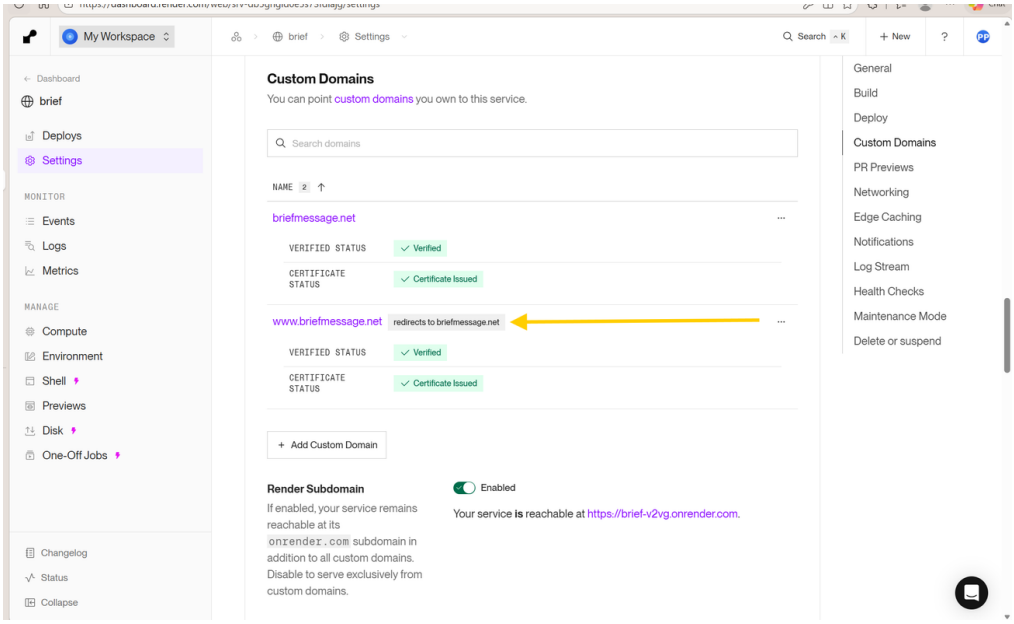
6. Domain and Email Record: Cloudflare

Item	State	Evidence	Status
DNSSEC	Active. The DS record was added automatically, because the domain is registered at Cloudflare.	"Success! briefmessage.net is protected with DNSSEC"	DONE
Email Routing	Enabled, DNS records locked. Destination onetechly@gmail.com verified. Rules: hello@ and support@, both active. Catch-all: disabled.	Routing rules page	DONE
Email test	A message sent to hello@briefmessage.net from another account at 22:35 arrived at 22:36.	Both inboxes	DONE
SSL/TLS mode	Full, chosen by Cloudflare's automatic mode. It only acts on proxied records, of which there are none now.	SSL/TLS overview	DONE

Item	State	Evidence	Status
Web records	Two CNAME records, briefmessage.net and www, both to brief-v2vg.onrender.com, both **DNS only**.	DNS records page, 05:06	DONE
The site	https://briefmessage.net opens Brief! with a valid certificate.	Section 1, picture	LIVE
Two-factor sign-in on the Cloudflare account	Not reported	-	YOU
Auto-renew of the domain	Not reported	-	YOU
Test of support@	Not reported	-	YOU

The seven DNS records

Name	Type	Content	Proxy	Purpose
briefmessage.net	CNAME	brief-v2vg.onrender.com	DNS only	The site
www	CNAME	brief-v2vg.onrender.com	DNS only	The site; Render redirects it to the main name
briefmessage.net	MX (three)	route1, route2, route3.mx.cloudflare.net	DNS only	Email Routing receives the domain's mail
briefmessage.net	TXT	v=spf1 include:_spf.mx.cloudflare.net ...	DNS only	SPF: who may send for the domain
cf2024-1._domainkey	TXT	v=DKIM1; ...	DNS only	DKIM: the signature of forwarded mail



Render, Settings, Custom Domains: both names verified, both certificates issued. Screenshot by the author.

Not there yet: a DMARC record. Cloudflare recommends one. It is best added together with the records of the service that will send Brief!'s mail, in 2.4, so that the two agree.

7. Predicted and Observed

OTSR v5 and Launch Roadmap v2 said what to expect. Comparing that with what happened is the most direct test of the reports themselves.

Predicted	Observed	
Tests run: 207, Failures: 0, Errors: 0, Skipped: 0	Exactly that, twice	YES
A notice beginning "Flyway upgrade recommended: H2 2.2.224 is newer", harmless	That notice, word for word, at WARN level; nothing else	YES
On an empty database, V1 then V2 are applied	On H2 in the tests and on PostgreSQL 16.15 on Render	YES
Start-up line "Database: PostgreSQL, //dpg-..." on Render	Present	YES
Five CI jobs; the Docker job is the Dockerfile's first real test	Five jobs, all green on the first run	YES
The Blueprint lists one web service and one database	brief and brief-db, both created	YES
Render adds www and redirects it to the main name	"redirects to briefmessage.net"	YES
Data survives a redeploy	Three posts still there after the forced push	YES
"The first build takes several minutes"	**Wrong in the detail.** The build took under a minute. The application start-up took two, which was not predicted at all.	PARTLY
Records are added as DNS only	**Not predicted:** Cloudflare's form switches the proxy on by default, so both records were first created proxied	PARTLY
The visitor's address arrives in CF-Connecting-IP	Not yet observed. The one-time DEBUG check has not been done	OPEN

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8. Defects Found and Lessons

Found during the first real run and the deployment. Items 1, 2, 5, 6 and 7 are defects in what was delivered; 3 and 4 are things the guides should have said.

#	Defect	Found by	Fix	Lesson
1	**A database file was published.** The .gitignore of 2.3.0 covered backend-spring/h2 but not an h2 folder at the top of the project, which appears when the jar is started from there. The first commit to the public repository contained h2/brief-spring.mv.db: the usernames and salted password hashes of local test accounts.	Reading the author's screenshot of the repository	Removed from the index, commit amended, forced push (39de99b replaced by d4b7db3). Passwords used locally are treated as exposed. 2.4 ignores every h2 folder, wherever it is.	An ignore rule must name the thing, not the place it is expected in. Review the file list of a first push before pushing.
2	**Anyone can register and post on the live site.** Known as "no bot check" in OTSR v5; deployment turned a note into an exposure.	This review	2.4: closed mode. Until then the address is shared by hand only.	A limitation changes weight the day the address is public.
3	The guide said "proxy status: DNS only" without saying that Cloudflare's form has the proxy switched on by default. Both records were created proxied.	The author's screenshot	Both switched to DNS only. Roadmap v3 says to turn the switch off.	Name the default when the instruction is to change it.
4	**Start-up takes 115 seconds on the free instance.** In the tests on the author's machine the same start takes about 11. A visitor who wakes a sleeping service waits two minutes or more.	The Render log	Paid instance before real use (no sleep, five times the processor). 2.4 looks at the start-up itself.	Measure on the machine it will run on.
5	**The rate limiter's clean-up is costly.** Above 10,000 remembered keys, every login attempt scans all of them. The new flood test takes 21 to 26 seconds where the whole class took 0.04.	The test times in the real run	2.4: clean up at most once per interval, not on every attempt.	A slow test is a measurement. Read the times, not only the count.
6	On the create-account form, "the two passwords are not the same" is shown twice after pressing the button.	The author's screenshot	2.4: one message.	Look at every state of a form, not only the happy one.
7	**The plan's validation gate cannot be run as written.** "Five teams for two weeks" on one board that everyone shares means five teams reading each other.	Writing this report	Roadmap v3: a pilot with one invited team on the closed board after 2.4; the five-team gate after private boards.	Walk through a plan step as the person who has to do it.
8	An address typed with a dot at the end (briefmessage.net.) answers "Not Found".	The author's screenshot	None needed: it is a different host name to Render. Recorded so it is recognised next time.	"Not Found" in plain text comes from Render's edge, not from Brief!.

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9. Security Posture: What Changed

The code is the code of OTSR v5, Section 9. What changed is that several rows moved from "built" to "observed", and that the application is now reachable.

Area	State after deployment	Status
Transport	HTTPS at briefmessage.net and www, certificates issued and renewed by Render; Render redirects HTTP to HTTPS	DONE
DNS	DNSSEC active	DONE
Signing key	Generated by Render, kept in the service's environment, never in the repository	DONE
Database	Foreign keys and unique keys in place on PostgreSQL. No inbound rule in render.yaml, so it should be reachable from Render's private network only; the Networking page has not been looked at yet	PARTLY
Container	Runs as the user "brief" (the log: "started by brief in /app")	DONE
Username and password rules	Seen working on the live form: availability check, strong-password rule, matching confirmation	DONE
Links in posts	Bare and full addresses open in a new tab, as designed	DONE
Login rate limit behind Render	Works; whether it counts per visitor or per proxy depends on the header, which has not been observed yet	OPEN
Registration	**Open to anyone, no bot check, no email**	HIGH
Moderation	**None.** No way to remove another member's post or an account, other than in the database	HIGH
Repository	Public. No secret was ever in it; one local database file was, for a few hours (Section 8, item 1)	FIXED
Backups	None: Render's free database has no backups	OPEN

10. Open Items

New, or changed by the deployment

#	Item	Effect	Priority
1	The site is open: anyone can register and post; no bot check, no moderation	Spam or abuse under the company's name. Low while nobody knows the address	HIGH
2	Free plans: the database expires on **November 10** (30 days after creation) and has no backups; the service sleeps after 15 idle minutes	After a 14-day grace period the database is deleted	HIGH
3	The visitor's address header has not been observed	If it is not CF-Connecting-IP, the lock-out counts per proxy address	MEDIUM

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#	Item	Effect	Priority
4	Start-up takes about two minutes on the free instance	A long first visit; deploys take that long to switch over	MEDIUM
5	Cloudflare account: two-factor sign-in and auto-renew not reported	The domain is only as safe as that login	MEDIUM
6	The onrender.com address still serves the site	Two addresses, two separate sign-ins; links to the old one keep working	LOW
7	Rate limiter clean-up scans every key on each attempt	Slow under a flood of new names	LOW
8	The repository is public, docs folder included	Roadmap and pricing ideas are readable by anyone	LOW
9	No DMARC record	Others could fake mail from the domain more easily	LOW
10	Not yet tried: support@, the database's Networking page, installing on a phone	Unconfirmed, not known to be wrong	LOW

The ten items of OTSR v5

#	Item in OTSR v5	Now
1	2.3.0 has not been run on the real stack	CLOSED 207 of 207
2	The Docker image has never been built	CLOSED Built in CI and by Render
3	The header Render uses is assumed, not observed	OPEN Item 3 above
4	No notification reaches a closed app	OPEN Planned with real accounts
5	Attachments are decided but not built	OPEN After private boards
6	No study copy of 2.3.0	CLOSED Not wanted
7	Flyway logs a notice about H2 2.2.224	ACCEPTED Seen, as expected
8	A pre-2.3 name with a tab or line break around it cannot sign in after V2	LOW Does not apply to the production database, which started empty
9	The Docker image serves the web build that is committed	LOW Unchanged
10	"Stay signed in" lasts 12 hours	LOW Unchanged

Still open from OTSR v4: rate-limit counts and signed-out tokens in one server's memory; mention look-up compares the post with every username; polling every 15 seconds; no email on accounts; one public board.

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11. What Comes Next

The plan is Launch Roadmap v3 (Brief_Launch_Roadmap_v3.pdf). In outline:

Milestone	Goal	Main contents	State
M0	The domain is safe and ready	DNSSEC, email forwarding done. Two-factor sign-in and auto-renew to confirm	DONE
M1 (2.3)	A build that can be deployed	Verified: 207 of 207, on H2 and PostgreSQL; Docker image builds	DONE
M2	briefmessage.net answers over HTTPS	GitHub, Render Blueprint, Cloudflare DNS	DONE
M3a (2.4)	**Accounts with email, and a closed board**	Email on accounts, verification link, password reset (through Resend). Closed mode: an invitation code to register, sign-in to read. The fixes of Section 8	NEXT
Pilot	One real team uses it	A team you invite, on the closed board, on the paid plans	NEXT
M3b (2.5)	Accounts, completed	Bot check, account deletion, Terms and Privacy pages, push notifications, longer sessions	LATER
M4 (2.6)	Private boards	Workspaces, invitations by email, roles, a landing page	LATER
Gate	Would teams pay?	Five teams, two weeks, free	LATER
M4a, M5, M6	Attachments, payment, launch	As in Roadmap v2	LATER

M3 was one milestone in Roadmap v2. It is split here for the reason 2.3 was kept small: email on accounts, three new flows and a mail provider are one step; push notifications are another. The closed mode is new, and answers Section 8, items 2 and 7.

12. Operating the Live Site

To do this	Do this
Deploy a change	`git push origin main`. GitHub Actions runs the five jobs; Render builds and deploys the same commit. Watch both. Render deploys even if a CI job fails, so read CI first.
See what the server is doing	Render > brief > Logs. After every start, look for the line that begins "Database: PostgreSQL".
Deploy again without a change	Render > brief > Manual Deploy > Deploy latest commit.
Stop the site quickly (spam, a mistake)	Render > brief > Settings > Delete or suspend > **Suspend**. The database is kept. Resume when ready.
Change the schema	Never edit V1 or V2. Add V3 as a new file; Flyway applies it at the next start. This is what 2.4 will do for email.
Run the application on your computer	From the backend-spring folder: `java -jar target\brief-spring.jar`. Started from another folder, it creates its h2 folder there.

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To do this	Do this
Before committing	`git status`. It must not list h2, target or node_modules.
The first visit is slow	The free instance was asleep. Wait up to two or three minutes; then it is fast until it has been idle for 15 minutes.
"Not Found" in plain text	The address is one Render does not know: check for a dot at the end, or a misspelling. Brief! itself never shows that page.

Four confirmations still wanted

1. **Cloudflare:** two-factor sign-in on, and auto-renew on for briefmessage.net.
2. **The visitor's address:** in Render > brief > Environment add `LOGGING_LEVEL_NET_ONETECHLY_BRIEF_SECURITY` = `DEBUG`, save, sign in once at briefmessage.net, copy the log line that begins "Client address" or "Header CF-Connecting-IP missing", then remove the variable.
3. **Render > brief-db > Networking:** a screenshot of the inbound rules. Do not include the password or either database URL.
4. **support@briefmessage.net:** one test message from another account. And, when you have the phone in hand, install Brief! from https://briefmessage.net.

> **Bottom line**
>
> In five days Brief! went from a second backend on one computer to a tested, containerised application on its own domain, with a database that keeps its data and a pipeline that tests every push. Nothing failed on its first real run. The defects this round were at the edges: an ignore rule, a default switch, a plan step. The next release closes the door that deployment opened.

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